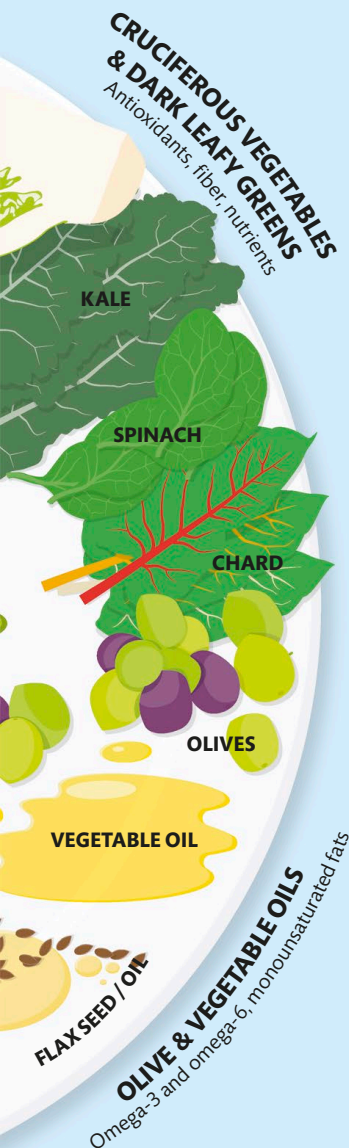


THE BRAIN IS 60 PERCENT FAT AND NEEDS A STEADY SUPPLY OF ENERGY



Essential nutrients

Certain nutrients from food have been found to improve or maintain particular brain functions. These substances include vitamins and minerals, omega-3 and omega-6 fatty acids, antioxidants, and water. These essential nutrients help keep brain cells healthy, enable the cells to transmit signals quickly and effectively, reduce damage from inflammation and free radicals (atoms that can damage cells, proteins, and DNA), and help the cells form new connections. They can also promote the production and function of neurotransmitters. As a result, regularly eating foods that contain these nutrients can benefit memory, cognitive functions, concentration, and mood.

NUTRIENT	BENEFIT	SOURCE
Omega-3 and omega-6 fatty acids	Help maintain blood flow and cell membranes in brain; support memory and reduce risk of depression, mood disorders, stroke, and dementia	- Oily fish (such as salmon, sardines, herring, mackerel) - Flaxseed oil, rapeseed oil - Walnuts, pine nuts, Brazil nuts
B vitamins	Vitamins B6 and B12 and folic acid support nervous-system function; choline helps production of neurotransmitters	- Eggs - Whole grains such as oatmeal, brown rice, whole grain bread - Cruciferous vegetables (cabbage, broccoli, cauliflower, kale) - Kidney beans, soy beans
Amino acids	Support production of neurotransmitters and aid memory and concentration	- Organic meat - Free-range poultry - Fish - Eggs - Dairy products - Nuts and seeds
Monounsaturated fats	Help keep blood vessels healthy and support functions such as memory	- Olive oil - Peanuts, almonds, cashews, hazelnuts, pecans, pistachios - Avocados
Antioxidants	Protect the brain cells from inflammation damage due to the presence of free radicals; improve cognitive functions and memory in older people	- Dark chocolate (at least 70 percent cocoa) - Berries - Pomegranates and juice - Ground coffee - Tea (especially green tea) - Cruciferous vegetables - Dark leafy greens - Soy beans and products - Nuts and seeds - Nut and seed butters, such as peanut butter and tahini
Water	Keeps brain hydrated to enable efficient chemical reactions	- Tap water (especially "hard" water) - Fruits and vegetables